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### Unit 3 : Tony Takes Out the Trash

It was almost 5 pm. Just like clockwork the sound of Fur Elise filled the air, echoing off the bare concrete walls of the homes along the street and the hard top of the road.

“I hope I'm not too late,” Tony said to his father as he ran for the door with a bag of garbage in his hand.

“Don't forget the recycling!” his father shouted as Tony dashed past him.

“Geeze,” the frantic boy replied. “I almost forgot.”

He dropped the trash on the curb and flew back into the house so fast that he practically left a trail of smoke in his wake. He searched from room to room for the recycling box as if his life depended on it. The music from the trucks was getting louder and louder as they approached. Tony's heart beat faster as he searched frantically for the recycling.

“Where is the recycling box?!” he screamed at the top of his lungs. “I can't find the stupid thing anywhere.”

“Just relax,” his dad said. “It's not the end of the world.”

Finally Tony found the box and his blood pressure dropped back to normal. It was between the refrigerator and the stove, where it always is. Somehow it never crossed his mind to look there first. But, in his defense, he was in a rush and not thinking clearly.

Tony reached the curb again just in time to throw the garbage into the back of the garbage truck. He covered his nose to prevent inhaling the ripe smell of rot and decay

that surrounded the truck. He held his breath, too, as long as he could. He finally exhaled as the recycling truck neared and gasped for fresh air. He handed the box to the man in the back who emptied it and then began to sort it out.

Tony sat down on the curb and breathed a sigh of relief. Thank god that's over, he thought. Then he felt a consoling pat on the back.

“You have to learn to relax, boy,” he father advised him. “You make such a big deal out of everything. It’s only the garbage.”

“I guess you're right,” Tony agreed. “Father knows best, right?” His dad only winked in agreement.